

Common Quality Practice CQP-304-10		
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Approved by (printed name and title):
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Purpose

The purpose of this CQP is to describe the process by which Lilly verifies serialization data at the request of external entities such as wholesalers, pharmacies, hospitals, regulatory bodies and patients.

The term “verification” used in this document refers to verifying the serialization data, or “product identifier,” which includes Global Trade Item Number (GTIN), serial number, batch number and expiry date.

Scope

The verification process defined in this document must be applied globally. This document also captures the specific verification requirements defined in the US Drug Supply Chain Security Act (DSCSA) which includes requirements for verification of Product Identifiers for suspect product investigation and saleable returns for requests made from authorized trading partners to Lilly.

This practice pertains to the following types of operations:

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| ☐ materials receipt | ☐ testing | ☐ storage |
| ☐ production | ☐ release | ☒ distribution |
| ☐ packaging and labeling | | |

This practice pertains to the following types of human health products:

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|--|--|
| ☐ raw materials | ☒ finished products |
| ☐ intermediates | ☐ medical devices |
| ☐ active pharmaceutical ingredients | ☒ drug/device combination products |
| ☐ bulk drug products | ☐ consumer products |
| ☐ drug products | ☐ other: N/A |

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1.0 Verification Process Overview

The serialization verification process steps are shown in the figure below. Each step is explained in detail in this practice.



Figure 1: Verification Process Steps

2.0 Receive Product Identifier Verification Requests

2.1 Sources of Requests Requests for Product Identifier verification may come from a variety of sources, including:

- Wholesaler,
- Retailer – Pharmacy,
- Hospital,
- HealthCare Provider (HCP),
- Patient,
- Law enforcement, and
- Regulator.

2.2 Request from a Trading Partner in US If the request for verification comes from a trading partner (wholesaler, retail pharmacy or hospital) in the US, then they must meet the “Authorized Trading Partner (ATP)” requirement in DSCSA regulation in order to receive a verification response. A trading partner is considered an ATP under the definition in DSCSA when they carry a valid license under the State Law.

2.2.1 Response to verification requests must not be provided if the trading partner does not meet the criteria for ATP.

2.2.2 Confirmation of the requestor’s authorized status can be accomplished by following steps in section 4.0 – Verify the Legitimacy of the Requestor.

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3.0 Collect Information from the Requester

3.1 Requestor Contact Information

- 3.1.1 The following contact information must be collected, as applicable, from the requestor if the requestor is a wholesaler, pharmacy, hospital or any business entity involved in selling/dispensing the product:
- Name, phone number and email address of the person contacting Lilly,
 - Business entity's company name, store number (if requestor is a pharmacy), address, phone number and corporate email address,
 - Registration number: depending on the type of registration that is required in the country where the requestor is located, collect the relevant registration information for the business entity such as State License, Pharmacy License, Data Universal Numbering System (DUNS), Drug Enforcement Administration (DEA), Hull Identification Number (HIN), etc., and
 - Sales order or purchase order if the business entity bought the product that is being inquired directly from Lilly.
- 3.1.2 If the requestor is a patient, HCP, law enforcement or regulatory agency, collect relevant contact information as provided.
- 3.1.3 The above information must be stored in the Global Customer Connect (GCC) system except for requests from law enforcement and regulatory agencies.

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3.0 Collect Information from the Requester

3.2 Product Information

- 3.2.1 The following product information must be obtained from the requestor to proceed with verification:
- Material Name,
 - Dosage / Strength,
 - Global Trade Item Number (GTIN),
 - Serial number,
 - Batch number,
 - Expiration Date, and
 - Background of the request:
 - What is the question/concern? (e.g., wants to verify serial number because they purchased the product from a new source OR the packaging looks different OR they received the product as a return from their downstream customer.),
 - Chain of custody information (Where was the product obtained by the requestor?),
 - Package quantity of the product, and
 - Photograph of the product, if available.
- 3.2.2 Request the product identifier information, which includes the GTIN, serial number, batch and expiry date be sent electronically, if that is possible. Ideally, a photograph is best method to verify this information.
- 3.2.3 The above information must be stored in the GCC system except for requests from law enforcement and regulatory agencies.

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4.0 Verify the Legitimacy of the Requestor

To prevent fraudulent activities that may be involved in a serialization verification request (Example: Phishing for copied or randomly generated serial numbers), due diligence must be taken to check the legitimacy of the requestor.

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| 4.1 For US Market | <p>4.1.1 For requests from trading partners (wholesaler, retail pharmacy or hospital):</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> a. Check the validity of the State License number leveraging external third-party vendor database (e.g., MedProID) or b. Search of Lilly Purchase Order (PO) number, if the requester is verifying a product purchased directly from Lilly. <p>4.1.2 If a determination is made that the requester is not an authorized trading partner, Global Security must be notified immediately.</p> |
| 4.2 For Other Countries | <p>4.2.1 Whenever possible, it is a good practice to check the authorized status of the trading partner such as wholesalers, pharmacies and hospitals before responding to their verification request using any means that is available in the market. This prevents any illegal, illegitimate parties from checking the validity of the serialization data in their possession to conduct any kind of fraudulent activities.</p> <p>4.2.2 If a determination is made that the requester is not an authorized trading partner, Global Security should be notified.</p> |
| 4.3 Request from Patients | <p>If a request to verify a product identifier is received from a patient, it is important to understand the reason for the request. If the request is to purely verify the serialization information, ask for proof of possession of the product package, such as requesting a picture of the product.</p> |

5.0 Verify the Product Identifier

When verifying serialization data, the combination of all the four key data elements (GTIN, serial number, batch number and expiration date) must be verified.

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| 5.1 Criteria for classifying the given serialization data as "Valid" | <p>5.1.1 The combination of the four key data elements (GTIN, serial number, batch number and expiry date) must exist in the Lilly serial number management system.</p> |
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5.0 Verify the Product Identifier

- 5.1.2 The system information matches the indicated product and dosage referenced in the request.
- 5.1.3 Object Status of that serial number does not show as “Inactive.”
- 5.1.4 The batch was released and destined for the country where the inquiry originated. This could help identify if the product has been diverted.
- 5.1.5 If a picture of the pack with the barcode is also available, an additional check should be done to scan the barcode and compare the data elements that are read from the barcode with the information that is printed in the human readable text.

6.0 Respond to Requestor

After completion of the verification activity, refer to CQP-302-2 – Authentication Capabilities and Analysis of Suspect Products to identify the right response statement to provide back to the requester. If the request for verification is from a requestor in the US market, there are special regulatory requirements which are detailed in this section below.

6.1 Request from a trading partner in US

- 6.1.1 A response can be provided to the trading partner only if the determination is made that they are an Authorized Trading Partner, by executing the steps in section 4.0.
- 6.1.2 A response must be provided to the requestor within 24 hours of receiving complete information. If the requestor did not provide complete information, Lilly must contact the requestor within 24 hours to request missing information.
- 6.1.3 Requests that are received outside the normal business hours of Monday through Friday must be addressed no later than the next business day.
- 6.1.4 The 24-hour time limit for response does not apply to other entities (Example: Patients, HCPs).

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6.0 Respond to Requestor

6.2 Requests from countries other than US

For verification requests from other countries, a response must be provided according to country-specific requirements or within a reasonable time.

6.3 Serialization data is valid as per criteria defined in section 5.0

Lilly must respond to the requester with the relevant response defined in CQP-302-2 – Authentication Capabilities and Analysis of Suspect Products along with a standard disclaimer that says that the Product Identifier is valid; however, the validity of the Product Identifier does not guarantee the authenticity of the packaging and/or product. No other information about the Product Identifier should be conveyed.

6.4 Serialization data is invalid as per criteria defined in section 5.0

6.4.1 Look for possibilities of errors in typing the information in the system. This will eliminate the possibility of human errors.

6.4.2 If the serialization data is determined to be invalid, this must be considered as a suspect product, and LQP-112-5 – Requirements for Reporting Illegitimate Product and Falsified Medicines to Regulatory Authorities must be followed. In addition, if the request is associated with a product complaint, follow GQS130 – Product Complaints.

7.0 Documenting Request and Verification

All verification requests and responses must be documented in Global Customer Connect (GCC) and stored for future reference for a record retention period as applicable as per local regulatory requirements, except for requests that may be received from specific entities such as law enforcement or regulators, which can be documented in an appropriate document management system (e.g., SmartLab/CMS).

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Revision History

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0	01-Jul-2021	First version of this Common Quality Practice.

Document Approval Signatures

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